

GSA GENERAL PLAYING RULES

Version 1.0: 2026/04/25

Important – Read This First

The GSA General Playing Rules are a distillation of the NSA Canada Official Rule Book combined with GSA specific rules.

1. If there is no GSA specific stated rule, the NSA Rule Book applies.
2. Where there is a GSA rule to clarify an NSA rule, or there is no comparable NSA rule, the GSA rule is in effect.
3. If a GSA rule exists and is in contradiction of an NSA rule, the GSA rule is in effect.

Several sections of the NSA Rule Book have been omitted as they do not apply in GSA league play, and hence section numbering may be missing some sections. Should there be any need to refer to the omitted rule, the reader is encouraged to refer to the complete NSA rule book.

If there are discrepancies during game play, the ruling of the game umpire is final.

Please forward any questions or requests for clarification to the GSA executive via email to softballgsa@gmail.com.

GSA SPECIFIC RULES

PITCHING/BATTING

1. No leadoffs. Runner is out if they leave the base before the ball is struck.
2. Pitcher must not advance beyond pitching screen and must end up behind it. The ruling when a batted ball strikes the pitcher is batter out; dead ball.
3. A batted ball contacting the pitching screen is a dead ball and does not count as a pitch.
4. No bunting. Any intentional bunt movement or chopping down at the ball may be counted as an automatic out **at the umpire's discretion**.
5. One team may not hit more than three (3) home runs (over the fence) more than the other team. Home runs hit over this limit are treated as walks.

Gender Parity Rules for Pitching/Batting:

1. From the top of the batting lineup, no more than two (2) male-identified players may bat sequentially until at least three (3) female-identified players have batted. Once three (3) females have batted, there are no restrictions on the remainder of the lineup construction.
2. The minimum number of female-identified players required to play is two (2). In the event a team has two females, the third female slot in the batting lineup will be counted as an automatic out.

COURTESY RUNNERS

1. The courtesy runner is the player that was last recorded out of the same gender. If no outs have been recorded, the last player in the batting order may serve as the courtesy runner.
2. If a batter elects to have a courtesy runner, the batter (as player) must thereafter occupy an infield defensive position and is not permitted to play any rover or outfield position. If the batter subsequently no longer requires a courtesy runner, that player may again occupy any defensive position.
3. The courtesy runner must start behind home plate (the runner "commit line") and may not cross the line until the ball is struck. Advancing past the line before the ball is struck will be treated as a leadoff, and the batter will be called out.
4. A courtesy runner may be substituted on the base path only in the event of injury.

FIELDING

1. Before the ball is hit:
 - a. Infielders must start play on the infield dirt and no more than one step inside the baseline.
 - b. No outfielder may start play on the infield dirt.
 - c. Up to two short fielders (rovers) are permitted between the infield dirt boundary and an arc 120 feet from home plate.
2. A defender standing on a base with no play being made to that base is guilty of obstruction. The result of the play is the baserunner advances an extra base at the discretion of the umpire.
3. An outfielder cannot initiate a force-out to first base UNLESS:
 - a. The batter passes first with the intention of continuing to second base.
 - b. The runner started on first base and is returning to first base to tag up.

Gender Parity Rules for Fielding:

1. A fielding lineup is expected to have three (3) female-identified players on the field at one time.
2. The minimum number of females required for play is two (2). In this event, the fielding team is limited to 9 fielders (*i.e.* you may not replace a missing female with another male).
3. There are NO RESTRICTIONS on where females can play. However, if only two females are fielding, neither of them may play the catcher position.

SCORING AND MERCY

1. INNING MERCY: If leading when going to bat, the inning mercy is 6 runs. If trailing, mercy is 6 runs or whatever is needed to take the lead by 1 run, whichever is higher. Unlimited in 8th and 9th innings.
2. GAME MERCY: If one team is leading by more than 15 runs after both teams have batted at least 7 times, the game is over via mercy and the final two innings are not scored.

GAME TIME AND PROCEDURES

1. Game slots are 90 minutes in length. A regulation game shall consist of no more than nine (9) innings.
2. If a game follows on the same field, no new inning will begin within 10 minutes of the end of the slot (*i.e.* 80 minutes after start).
3. No new inning after 90 minutes of game time if it is the only game on a field that day, at umpire's discretion.
4. The home team is responsible for setting up and taking down the bases/pitching screen, and shutting down the lights, as appropriate.

ALCOHOL

The GSA has a zero-tolerance policy towards alcohol. Absolutely no alcohol consumption is permitted on McMaster property, which includes the playing fields, the spectator areas, and the parking lots.

RULE 1 – DEFINITIONS

RULE 1 Sec 1

ALTERED BAT: A bat is considered altered when the physical structure of a legal bat has been changed. Examples of altering a bat are replacing the handle of the metal bat with another type handle, or inserting material inside the bat. A flare, cone grip or a painted bat is considered an altered bat. **EXAMPLE:** If the umpire can't hold the bat by the knob with two fingers in the shape of a "V" then it is a flare cone and an altered bat. **EFFECT:** The ball is dead, the batter is out and baserunners may not advance. The batter is ejected for using an altered bat.

RULE 1 Sec 4

BASE PATH: The base path is an imaginary line, three (3) feet on either side of a direct line between the bases.

RULE 1 Sec 5

BASERUNNER: A player on the team at bat, who has finished his/her batting turn, reached any base, and has not yet been put out.

RULE 1 Sec 6

BATTER'S BOX: The area in which the batter is restricted to, while in position to bat. The batter must have both feet entirely within the lines of the box prior to the pitch (the lines are considered to be within the box). If the batter steps outside of the batter's box and in front of home plate, while swinging at the pitched ball, they may be declared out by the umpire.

RULE 1 Sec 7

BATTER-BASERUNNER: A player who has finished his turn at bat, but has not yet been put out, or touched first base.

RULE 1 Sec 8

BATTING ORDER: The batting order is the official lineup of offensive players, listing the order in which team member must come to bat.

RULE 1 Sec 9

BLOCKED BALL: A live ball that is touched, stopped, or handled by a person not engaged in the game; or which touches any object that is not part of the official equipment or playing area.

EFFECT: The ball is dead. See Rule 8, Sec. 5(e) for enforcement.

NOTE: A blocked ball is not called when a live ball strikes a base coach unintentionally.

NOTE: For offensive equipment causing a blocked ball, the runner closest to home plate will be declared out and all other runners must return to the last base touched when the ball becomes blocked.

RULE 1 Sec 10

CATCH: A catch is a legally caught ball that occurs when a fielder secures a batted or thrown ball with his/her hand or glove. If the ball is merely held in the fielder's arms or prevented from dropping to the ground by some part of the fielder's body or clothing, the catch is not complete until the ball is in the grasp of the fielder's hand or glove. It is not a catch if a fielder, immediately after he/she contacts the ball, collides with another player or wall (fence), or falls to the ground and drops the ball as a result of the collision or falling to the ground. In establishing a valid catch, the fielder shall have complete control of the ball, and his/her release of the ball is voluntary and intentional. If a player drops the ball while in the act of throwing, it is a valid catch.

NOTE: An intentionally dropped ball is a ball that has first been caught, by the definition of a catch, and is then intentionally dropped in an attempt to confuse or obtain additional outs.

EFFECT: The ball is dead, the batter-baserunner is called out, and all other runners are protected under the obstruction rule.

Play 1 – A batted fly ball, before touching the ground, strikes F5 on the head, and while still in the air, is caught by F6.

RULING: A legally caught fly ball by F6. Batter is out.

Play 2 – The batter hits a sharp line drive, which after passing F4, strikes the umpire over fair ground. The ball ricochets and is caught by F4 while still in flight.

RULING: No catch. Ball is alive and batter would have to be thrown out or tagged out. A ball which strikes anything other than a defensive player, while in flight, is ruled the same as having struck the ground.

RULE 1 Sec 13

CHOPPED BALL OR BUNTED BALL:

a. Chopped Ball When the batter strikes downward with a chopping motion so that the ball bounces high into the air this is considered a chopped ball. The chopping motion should resemble that of chopping a piece of wood lying on the ground.

b. Bunted Ball A bunt is a fair ball in which the batter does not take a full swing to hit the ball, but holds the bat in such a manner, in the path of the ball, to tap the ball slowly into the infield.

RULE 1 Sec 15

DEAD BALL: The ball is not in play and not considered in play again, until the pitcher has the ball in his possession and the umpire has called “play ball”.

a. **DELAYED DEAD BALL:** An infraction, signaled by the umpire, in which the ball remains alive until all play has been completed and the umpire calls time.

RULE 1 Sec 16

FAIR BALL: A fair ball is a batted ball that:

a. Settles on fair territory between home plate and first base or home plate and third base.

b. Is on or over fair territory, including any part of first and third bases, when bounding toward the outfield, or touches first, second, or third base.

c. First falls in fair territory beyond first or third base.

d. While in or over fair territory, touches the person of any umpire or player.

e. While over fair territory, passes out of the playing field beyond the outfield fence.

NOTE: A fair fly shall be judged according to the relative position of the ball and foul line and not as to the position of the fielder at the time he/she touches the ball. It does not matter whether the ball first touches fair or foul territory, as long as it does not touch anything foreign to the natural ground in foul territory and complies with other aspects of a fair ball. Home plate is in fair territory.

Play 1 – Batted ball first hits foul ground, and before being touched, rolls into fair territory between home and first base where it settles.

RULING: Fair ball.

RULE 1 Sec 17

FLAGRANT PLAYER OBSTRUCTION: A defensive fielder shall not at any time flagrantly, and with excessive force, impede the batter-baserunner or baserunner.

PENALTY: Immediate ejection of the defensive player.

RULE 1 Sec 18

FORCE OUT: A force out is an out which can be made only when a baserunner loses the right to the base he is occupying because the batter becomes a batter-baserunner, and before the batter-baserunner or a succeeding baserunner has been put out.

RULE 1 Sec 19

FOUL BALL: A foul ball is a batted ball that:

a. Settles on foul territory between home and first base or home and third base.

b. Bounds past first and third base on or over foul territory.

c. Falls first on foul territory beyond first or third base.

d. While on or over foul ground, touches an umpire, player, or foreign object to the natural ground.

e. Touches the batter, or bat in the batter’s hand, while within the lines of the batter’s box.

NOTE: A foul fly ball shall be judged according to the relative position of the ball and the foul line, and not the position of the fielder.

RULE 1 Sec 20

ILLEGAL BAT: An illegal bat is one that does not meet the requirements of Rule 3, Sec. 1.

NOTE: The batter is NOT ejected for using an illegal bat.

RULE 1 Sec 21

ILLEGALLY BATTED BALL: An illegally batted ball occurs when:

- a. A batter's entire foot is completely out of the box, on the ground, when he/she hits the ball, fair or foul.
- b. Any part of the batter's foot is touching home plate or strike mat when he/she hits the ball.
- c. The batter hits the ball with an illegal bat.

RULE 1 Sec 22

ILLEGALLY CAUGHT BALL: Occurs when a fielder catches a batted or thrown ball with his cap, illegal glove, or any part of his/her uniform detached from its proper place. See Rule 1, Sec. 10.

RULE 1 Sec 23

ILLEGAL PLAYER: A player who enters the line-up without the right to the offensive or defensive position.

Examples of an illegal player (but not limited to) are:

1. Illegal use of the re-entry rule
2. Illegal use of the courtesy runner rule
3. Using a player to pitch who was removed from the pitching position
4. Unreported substitute
5. Player(s) that are listed on two (2) or more Official NSA sanctioned rosters without an official release form on file in the Provincial Director's office.

RULE 1 Sec 24

INELIGIBLE PLAYER: A player who is unregistered or who does not meet requirements to register.

Examples of an ineligible player (but not limited to) are:

1. Playing under an assumed name
2. Players not on the team roster
3. Violating residence requirements
4. Violating divisional age requirements

NOTE: Use of an ineligible player will result in a forfeit of the game if appealed properly.

RULE 1 Sec 25

IN JEOPARDY: A term indicating that the ball is in play and an offensive player may be put out.

RULE 1 Sec 26

INFIELD FLY: An infield fly is a fair ball, not including a line drive, which can be caught by an infielder with ordinary effort when first and second or first, second, and third bases are occupied, before two (2) are out. Any fielder can catch an infield fly.

NOTE: When it seems apparent that a batted ball will be an infield fly, the umpire shall immediately declare "INFIELD FLY - BATTER IS OUT" to aid the runners. If the ball is near the foul lines, the umpire shall declare "INFIELD FLY - BATTER IS OUT, IF FAIR". The ball is live and runners may advance at the risk of the ball being caught or retouch and advance after a fielder touches the ball. If the hit ball becomes a foul ball, it is treated the same as any other foul ball.

RULE 1 Sec 27

INNING: An inning is that portion of a game within which the teams alternate between offense/defense and there are three (3) outs for each team.

RULE 1 Sec 28

INTERFERENCE: Interference is the act of an offensive player or team member, which impedes or confuses a defensive player while attempting to execute a play. If judged so by the umpire, vocal interference may be called. See Rule 7, Section 3 for further details.

RULE 1 Sec 29

LEGAL TOUCH: A legal touch occurs when a baserunner or batter-baserunner, who is not touching a base,

is touched by the ball while the ball is held securely in a fielder's hand. The ball is not considered as being securely held if it is juggled or dropped by the fielder after having touched the runner, unless the runner deliberately knocks the ball from the hand of the fielder. It is sufficient for the fielder to touch the runner with the glove, which holds the ball.

RULE 1 Sec 30

LEGALLY CAUGHT BALL: A legally caught ball occurs when a fielder catches a batted or thrown ball, provided the ball is not caught in the fielder's cap, hat, pocket, protector, or any other part of his/her uniform. It must be caught and firmly held with the hand or the glove.

RULE 1 Sec 31

OBSTRUCTION: Obstruction is the act of:

- a. A defensive player or team member which hinders or prevents a batter from striking or hitting a pitched ball
NOTE: Catcher obstruction is called when the catcher obstructs the batter IN ANY WAY who is attempting to hit or swing at a pitch. Prior to the pitch, catcher obstruction does not apply, a dead ball shall be called and allow the batter to re-set themselves.
- b. A fielder, while not in possession of the ball, or not in the act of fielding a batted ball, or not about to receive a thrown ball, impedes the progress of a baserunner who is legally running the bases.

RULE 1 Sec 32

OVERSLIDE: An overslide is the act of the offensive player sliding over and beyond a base he is attempting to reach. This is usually caused when his/her momentum causes him/her to lose contact with the base, which then causes him/her to be in jeopardy. The batter-baserunner may overslide first base, without being in jeopardy, if he/she immediately returns to that base.

RULE 1 Sec 33

OVERTHROW: An overthrow is a play in which a ball is thrown and goes into foul territory, beyond the boundary lines of the playing field or becomes blocked.

RULE 1 Sec 36

The **scoring line** is a line drawn from the point of home plate closest to third base, parallel to the first base foul line, and extending eight (8) feet through foul territory.

RULE 1 Sec 37

STEALING: The act of a runner attempting to advance during the pitch or after the pitch has reached home plate is considered to be the act of stealing.

RULE 1 Sec 39

THREE-FOOT LINE: Is a line parallel to and three feet from the first base line, in foul territory, starting at a point fifteen (15) feet from home plate and running all the way to first base. The batter-baserunner is declared out when he/she runs outside the three-foot line, and in the judgment of the umpire, interferes, intentionally or unintentionally, with the fielder attempting to field a batted ball, or interfering with a thrown ball.

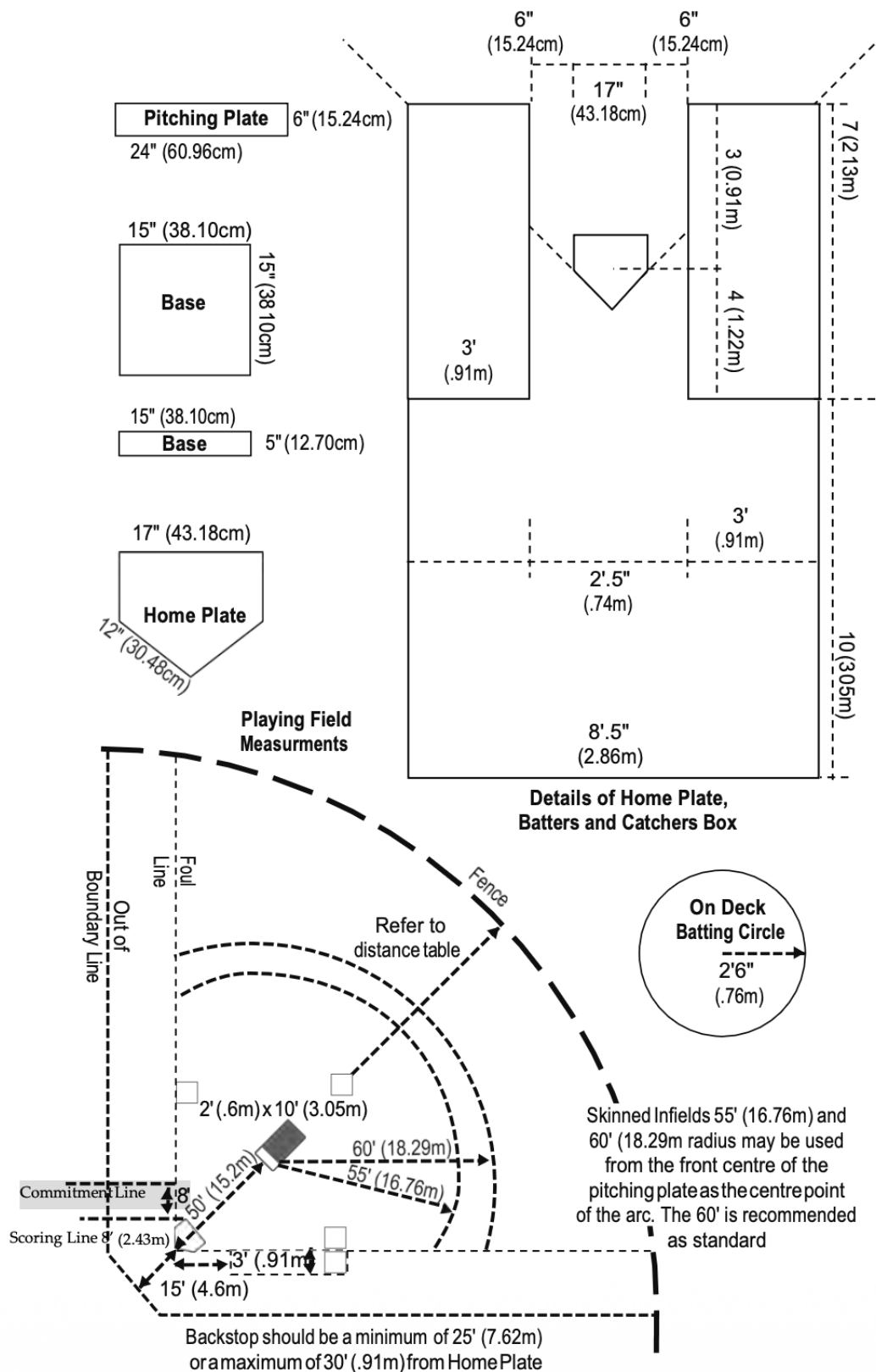
RULE 1 Sec 40

TIME: The term used by the umpire to order suspension of play.

RULE 1 Sec 41

TURN AT BAT: A player's turn at bat begins when he enters the batter's box and continues until he/she is put out or becomes a baserunner.

PLAYING FIELD DIMENSIONS



RULE 2 – THE PLAYING FIELD

RULE 2 Sec 1

THE PLAYING FIELD IS THE AREA within which the ball may be legally played and fielded. The playing field shall have a clear and unobstructed area within radius of the prescribed fence distances from home plate between the foul lines.

a. ADULT DIVISIONS MINIMUM DISTANCE

All 275 feet

RULE 2 Sec 2

GROUND RULES OR SPECIAL RULES establishing the limits of the playing field may be agreed upon by leagues or opposing teams whenever backstops, fences, stands, vehicles, spectators, or other obstructions are within the prescribed area.

RULE 2 Sec 3

THE PLAYING FIELD LAYOUT should include, in addition to marking for foul lines, the following:

f. **THE SCORING LINE** is a line drawn from the point of home plate closest to third base, parallel to the first base foul line, extending (8) feet through foul territory. To score a run, a runner must be touching the ground on or past this scoring line before a fielder has possession of the ball while standing on home plate or the strike mat.

1. If a runner touches any part of home plate or the strike mat while the scoring line is in use, they are out and their run does not score

g. **A COMMITMENT LINE** shall be drawn eight (8) feet up the third base foul line from the point of home plate closest to third base, parallel to the first base foul line.

h. Once a runner has touched or crossed this commitment line they must proceed home. Any attempt to reverse their path or stop their forward progress will result in the runner being called out.

EXCEPTION: A runner is permitted to return to third base to tag up on a caught fly ball

EXCEPTION: A runner is not out for stopping to avoid a collision with a defensive player

RULE 2 Sec 6

IF, DURING THE COURSE of any game, the base distance or pitching distance is found to be in error; the error should be corrected immediately, and the game should be continued. This is not a point to be protested.

RULE 3 – EQUIPMENT

NOTE I*: NSA Canada reserves the right to approve or reject any softball related equipment for its intended use in the NSA Canada Program. Equipment does not merely need to meet industry standards but must meet NSA Canada Standards before approval for its use is granted. Should NSA Canada believe in any way, shape, or form that a particular piece of equipment is dangerous and/or not acceptable for fair play; NSA Canada reserves the right to ban such equipment immediately.

NOTE II**: NSA Canada has adopted a Bat Performance Factor (BPF) of 1.20 or less. All bats with a BPF of 1.20 or less for the entire length of the barrel or hitting surface are approved for use in the NSA Canada Program, unless NSA Canada believes in any way, shape, or form that a particular bat is dangerous and/or not acceptable for fair and safe play. NSA Canada reserves the right to ban such equipment immediately. All bats used in NSA Canada play must be stamped with a BPF of 1.20 or less.

NOTE III: Wooden bats are not permitted.

RULE 3 Sec 1

THE OFFICIAL BAT should be made of aluminum. Below is a list of additional requirements:

a. The bat shall not be more than 34 inches in length and no more than 38 ounces in weight and shall meet the BPF standard of 1.20 on the entire length of the barrel (see above NOTE I* and NOTE II** for further bat

standards) and shall have BPF 1.20 permanently stamped by the manufacturer. Examples of the stamps required for this BPF 1.20 standard are available on the NSA Canada website.

b. The bat shall have a safety grip of cork, tape (not smooth plastic type), or combination material.

c. The grip shall not be less than ten (10) inches long and shall not extend more than fifteen (15) inches from the small end of the bat.

d. The bat shall be marked "OFFICIAL SOFTBALL" or "SLOW PITCH ONLY" by the manufacturer.

NOTE I: If the words "OFFICIAL SOFTBALL" cannot be read, due to normal wear, the bat shall be declared legal, if it is legal in all other aspects.

NOTE II: Any bat marked as "FASTPITCH ONLY" shall not be legal for play in NSA Canada slow pitch events.

e. The bat may be made of metal and a metal bat may be angular, however, NSA Canada must approve any metal material before it is used in Sanctioned Events.

f. All exposed surfaces of the bat must be smooth and free of burrs, pins, rivets, DEEP DENTS, OR DANGEROUS DENTS, FRACTURES OF ANY TYPE, sharp edges, or any type of exterior fastener that would present a safety hazard.

EXCEPTION: At the umpire's discretion, slightly dented bats may be considered legal.

g. Unless the bat is made of one-piece construction with the barrel end closed, it should have a rubber or plastic insert in the barrel.

h. A one-piece rubber grip and knob combination is illegal.

i. Metal bats must have a knob on the handle and welded or mechanically fastened.

j. All bats must have a safety knob of a minimum of 1/4 inch protruding at a 90-degree angle from the handle. The knob portion of the bat may be taped as long as the bat does not exceed 34 inches in length, however, the umpire may request tape to be removed from both the handle and the knob, if there is any question concerning the bat being altered or illegal. After determining the bat legal, the player may tape the bat back to his/her preference, providing the bat meets the requirements set forth by Rule 3, Sec. 1 a-l.

k. A flare or cone grip attached to the bat will be considered an altered bat if the flare or cone is smooth throughout its length and the grip does not leave at least 1/8 inch of safety knob of the bat exposed.

l. Shall be rounded and shall be smooth. Shall not be more than 2 1/4 inches in diameter at its largest part. A tolerance of 1/16 inch is permitted, to allow for expansion on a round bat. Three sided bats are now illegal for NSA Canada play.

NOTE I: Rule 3, Sec. 1 a-l. Any bat that does not comply with these guidelines must be removed from the game, and the bat may no longer be used in any NSA Canada Sanctioned Play.

GLOVES MAY BE WORN by any player. Multicoloured gloves are acceptable for all players, including the pitcher.

RULE 3 Sec 2

THE OFFICIAL SOFTBALL shall be a smooth seamed, concealed stitched or flat surfaced ball. The center of the ball may be made of either long fiber kapok or mixture of cork and rubber, and or machine wound, with a fine twisted yarn and covered with latex or rubber cement. Or it may be made of other materials approved by NSA Canada. The cover of the ball shall be Optic Yellow, tanned horsehide, cowhide, or any other materials approved by NSA Canada, cemented to the ball by application of cement to the underside of the cover and sewn with waxed cotton or linen thread. The solid core ball must be stamped with an official NSA logo and may not bear any other logos except for the NSA official logo. Along with the logo, the ball must be stamped with a co-efficient .52, .47, .44, .40 or less and must be black stitched.

RULE 3 Sec 3

GLOVES MAY BE WORN by any player. Multicoloured gloves are acceptable for all players, including the pitcher.

RULE 3 Sec 4

ALL PLAYERS, COACHES, AND PARTICIPANTS MUST WEAR SHOES. Sandals are considered proper shoes for non-players only. A shoe shall be made with either canvas or leather uppers or similar materials. The sole may be either smooth or have soft or hard rubber or polyurethane cleats. Metal cleats or any type of shoe that has exposed metal on the sole, other than a rivet, may not be worn in any division of play. Shoes that have steel or any type of metal tips on the cleats such as (but not limited to) soccer shoes, golf shoes, football, and track shoes are illegal.

PENALTY: No player will be allowed to compete in NSA Canada play who is not wearing proper shoes. If it is discovered during the game that a player is wearing improper shoes, or no shoes, the team must use a substitute until such time as the player puts on the proper shoes.

RULE 3 Sec 5

NO EQUIPMENT. Shall be left lying on the field, either in foul or fair territory. Any such equipment must be secured in the team's dugout. See Rule 8, Section 5 for issues pertaining to blocked ball.

RULE 3 Sec 7

RECOMMENDATION. NSA Canada, in all NSA Canada play HIGHLY recommends protective equipment for softball. This includes, but is not limited to, batting helmets, face masks, shin guards, chest protectors. (Please note that the use of any form of protective equipment is at the individual participants discretion unless the league/tournament the participant chose to play in has made certain protective equipment mandatory within their guidelines and or rules)

NOTE I: Any player that teases or taunts another player for using ANY form of protective equipment shall be immediately ejected from the game without warning.

RULE 4 – PLAYERS AND SUBSTITUTIONS

RULE 4 Sec 3

ANY OF THE STARTING PLAYERS may be withdrawn from the game and re-entered once, provided that the players occupy the original position in the batting order whenever in the game.

NOTE I: The original player and his/her substitute cannot be in the game at the same time.

a. Violation of the re-entry rule results in the use of an illegal player. Penalty shall be the immediate ejection of the ineligible player when the violation is brought to the attention of the umpire, by the offended team.

b. Violation of the re-entry rule is handled as an appeal play, which can be made anytime during the game.

RULE 4 Sec 4

A TEAM MUST HAVE the required number of players to start or continue a game. Requirements are:

a. A team must have a minimum of eight (8) players, with which it started the game.

b. If a team starts without extra players and any player is removed, injured, or ejected from the game, with no substitute to replace the removed, injured, or ejected player, the vacated spot automatically becomes an out each time the vacant spot comes to bat.

NOTE I: If a team has a vacant spot and a substitute arrives, he/she must be inserted into the vacant spot immediately.

NOTE II: A team may continue to play with more than one (1) vacant spot if it started with more than one extra player.

RULE 4 Sec 7

COURTESY RUNNERS

b. Courtesy runners may be anyone on the team's roster.

d. Courtesy runners may be replaced with another courtesy runner.

e. A substitute may be made for the ORIGINAL RUNNER to replace the courtesy runner.

f. If the courtesy runner is on base when they are due up to bat, they will be declared out as a batter and will remain on the base currently occupied.

RULE 5 – THE GAME

RULE 5 Sec 2

THE FITNESS OF THE GROUNDS for a game shall be decided solely by the Umpire or the head grounds keeper.

RULE 5 Sec 3

A REGULATION GAME shall consist of seven (7) innings. A regulation game officially begins when the

defensive team has taken the field and the umpire indicates (verbally or physically) play ball. A full seven (7) innings need not be played if the home team (the team second at bat) scores more runs in six innings or before the third out of the seventh inning

NOTE I: The game is officially over when:

1. The umpire assigned to the game have left the playing field
2. A new game has started on the playing field
3. The umpire declares that the game is over

EXCEPTION: Run Rules: All classes will use twenty (20) runs after three (3) innings, fifteen (15) runs after four (4) innings, and ten (10) runs after five (5) or more innings. If the home team is ahead by the above listed runs after 2 1/2, 3 1/2 or 4 1/2 innings, the home team shall be declared the winner and the game declared complete.

b. The umpire is empowered to call a game at any time because of darkness, rain, fire, panic, or other causes that place the patrons or players in peril.

c. These provisions do not apply to any acts on the part of the players or spectators, which might call for the forfeiture of the game. The umpire may forfeit the game if attacked physically by any team member or spectator.

d. The umpire shall forfeit a game in favour of a team not at fault in the following cases:

1. If a team fails to appear on the field, or being on the field, refuses to begin a game at the time the team is scheduled to play, or within a time set for forfeitures (grace period) by the organization in which the team is playing.
2. If after the game has started, one team refuses to continue play unless the game has been suspended or terminated by the umpire.
3. If after the umpire has suspended the game, one side fails to resume playing within two (2) minutes after the umpire has called "play ball".
4. If a team uses tactics to delay or to hasten the game.
5. If, after being warned by the umpire, any one of the rules is willfully violated.
6. If the order for the removal of a player or manager/coach, from the game is not obeyed within one (1) minute.
7. If for any reason there are less than eight (8) players on a team.

EXCEPTION: See Rule 4, Sec. 1

8. The score of a forfeited game will be 7 - 0 to the winning team.

NOTE I: Players not listed in the lineups and not available at game time, may be substituted for.

g. In the event that a game cannot be completed, an official game may be called after five (5) innings of play or 4 1/2 innings of play, if the home team is ahead.

RULE 5 Sec 4

THE WINNER OF THE GAME shall be the team that scores the most runs in a regulation game. The score of a called regulation game shall be the score at the end of the last complete inning, unless the home team has scored more runs than the visiting team in the incomplete inning. In this case, the score shall be that of the incomplete inning.

RULE 5 Sec 5

A RUN SHALL NOT BE SCORED IF THE THIRD OUT OF THE INNING IS A RESULT OF:

- a. The batter being put out before legally touching first base.
- b. A baserunner being forced out due to the batter becoming a batter-baserunner.
- c. A baserunner leaving base before a pitched ball reaches home plate or before the pitched ball is batted.
- d. An appeal play at first base on the batter-baserunner for the third out of the inning.

RULE 5 Sec 6

NO SUCCEEDING RUNNER shall score a run when a preceding runner has been declared the third out of an inning.

RULE 5 Sec 7

A BASERUNNER SHALL not score a run ahead of the baserunner preceding him/her in the batting order, if the preceding baserunner has not been put out.

RULE 5 Sec 10

HOME RUN LIMITS: (any ball clearly over the fence in fair territory, regardless of being touched or deflected)

a. Three (3) and one up

NOTE I: The one up rule is in effect only after both teams have reached their home run limit. Once both teams have reached their home run limit, either team may hit an additional home run, however, no team may ever go more than one home run up on the other team. Any additional home runs above the one up will be treated as a walk for the batter.

Exception: If the visiting team is even or up one home run on the home team in the bottom of the last inning or any extra innings, the home team may hit only one home run in that inning.

RULE 5 Sec 11

ANY BALL clearly over the fence in fair territory, regardless of being touched or deflected, exceeding a team's home run total, will be scored as a walk.

NOTE I: Any batted ball that is clearly over the fence in fair territory, regardless of being touched or deflected, shall be considered a home run against the team's home run total.

RULE 5 Sec 12

ANY BALL ASSISTED OVER THE FENCE by a defensive player in fair territory before striking the ground, shall not be included in the total of over the fence home runs. This is a four-base award.

RULE 7 – BATTING

RULE 7 Sec 1

THE BATTER SHALL TAKE HIS/HER POSITION WITHIN THE LINES OF THE BATTER'S BOX.

a. The batter shall not have his/her entire foot touching the ground completely outside the lines of the batter's box or touching home plate or the strike mat when the ball is hit.

b. The batter shall not step directly across in front of the catcher to the other side of the batter's box while the pitcher is in a position to pitch.

EFFECT: Sec. 1(a - b) The ball is dead, the batter is out, baserunners may not advance.

c. The batter shall not enter the batter's box with an illegal bat.

EFFECT: The opposing team has the option of taking the result of the play, or the ball is dead, the batter is out, baserunners may not advance.

d. The batter shall not enter the batter's box with an altered bat.

EFFECT: The ball is dead, the batter is out, and without warning, is ejected from the game. Baserunners may not advance. NSA Canada's policy on supplementary discipline for the use of an altered bat can be found on the NSA Canada web site under the Altered Softball Bat Policy.

RULE 7 Sec 2

EACH PLAYER OF THE SIDE AT BAT shall become a batter in the order in which his/her name appears on the score sheet. The batting order must be followed throughout the entire game, unless a player is substituted for. When this occurs, the substitute must take the place of the player he/she is replacing in the batting order. The first batter in each inning shall be the batter whose name follows that of the last player who completed a turn at bat in the preceding inning.

NOTE I: Batting out of order is an appeal play, which may be made by the defensive team only.

a. If the error is discovered while the incorrect batter is at bat, the correct batter takes his/her place and legally assumes any balls and strikes.

b. If the error is discovered after the incorrect batter has batted, and before the next pitch to the following batter, the player who should have batted is out. Any advance or score made because of a batted ball by the improper batter's advance to first base on a hit, error, or a base on balls shall be nullified. The next batter is the player whose name follows that of the player called out for failing to bat.

c. If the error is discovered after the first pitch to the next batter, the turn at bat of the incorrect batter is legal, all runs scored and bases run are legal and the next batter shall be the one whose name follows that of the incorrect batter. No one is called out for failure to bat. Players who have not batted and who

have not been called out have lost their turn at bat until reached again in the regular order.

d. No baserunner shall be removed from the base he/she is occupying to bat in his/her proper place. He/she merely misses his/her turn at bat with no penalty. The batter following him/her in the batting order becomes the legal batter.

e. When the third out of the inning is made before the batter has completed his/her turn at bat, he/she shall be the first batter in the next inning and shall have the ball and strike count on him/her canceled.

RULE 7 Sec 3

MEMBERS OF THE TEAM AT BAT shall not interfere, either physically or vocally, with a player attempting to field either a fair or foul ball. This includes a base coach. Interference is described as affecting the outcome of a defensive play.

EFFECT: The ball is dead, the batter is out, and any baserunner(s) must return to the base that they occupied at the time of the pitch.

RULE 7 Sec 4

THE BATTER SHALL NOT hit a fair ball a second time with the bat in fair territory.

EFFECT: The ball is dead, the batter is out and baserunners may not advance.

EXCEPTION: If the batter is standing in the batter's box and contact is made while the bat is in the batter's hands, it is a foul ball even if the ball is hit a second time over fair territory.

NOTE I: If the batter drops the bat and the ball rolls against the bat in fair territory, and in the umpire's judgment, there was no intention to interfere with the course of the ball, the batter is not out and the ball is alive and in play.

RULE 7 Sec 7

A FAIR BALL IS A LEGALLY batted ball which:

- a. Settles or is touched on fair ground between home and first base or home and third base.
- b. Bounds past first or third base on or over fair ground.
- c. Touches first, second, or third base.
- d. While on or over fair ground, touches the person or clothing of an umpire or player.
- e. First falls on fair territory beyond first or third base. A fair fly ball must be judged according to relative position of the ball and the foul line, regardless of whether the fielder is on fair or foul ground at the time he/she touches the ball.

EFFECT: Rule 7, Sec. 7(a - e) The ball is in play and baserunners are entitled to advance any number of bases with liability to be put out. The batter becomes a batter-baserunner unless the infield fly rule applies.

f. While on or over fair ground, lands behind a fence or into a stand beyond the outfield fence, this is a home run.

g. Hits a foul pole on the fly. If the ball hits the pole above the fence level, it shall be a home run.

RULE 7 Sec 8

A FOUL BALL IS A LEGALLY batted ball which:

- a. Settles on foul ground between home and first base or between home and third base.
- b. Bounds past first or third base on or over foul ground.
- c. First touches on foul ground beyond first or third base.
- d. While on or over foul ground, touches the person or clothing of an umpire or player, or it is blocked.
- e. Is caught while over foul ground.

EFFECT: Rule 7, Sec. 8(a - d) The ball is dead. A strike is called on the batter for each foul ball, including the third strike. Baserunners must return to their bases without liability to be put out. Baserunners may not advance on a third strike foul ball, including a legally caught foul ball, however, all runners may advance on any other legally caught foul ball.

RULE 7 Sec 9

THE BATTER IS OUT:

- a. When the third pitch is missed, struck foul, or touches any part of the batter's person.
- b. When a batter appears in the batter's box with, or is discovered using an illegal or altered bat, prior to or after hitting the ball. The batter is also ejected from the game for using an altered bat.

- c. When a fly ball is legally caught.
- d. Immediately when he/she hits an infield fly, and the umpire has declared "'Infield Fly". Refer to Rule 1, Sec. 27.
- e. If a fielder intentionally drops, or lets fall untouched, a fair fly ball, including a line drive, which can be caught by an infielder with ordinary effort with first base occupied with less than two (2) outs.
EFFECT: Rule 7, Sec. 9 The ball is dead, the batter is out, and baserunners must return to the last base touched at the time of the pitch.
NOTE I: A trapped ball shall not be considered as having been intentionally dropped.
- f. If a preceding runner, in the umpire's judgment, intentionally interferes with a fielder who is attempting to catch a thrown ball or is attempting to throw a ball in an attempt to complete a play, the offending runner and the succeeding are both declared out.
- g. When the batter bunts or chops the ball downward. (See Rule 1, Sec. 13).
- h. Any batter-baserunner that carries the bat and legally reaches or touches first base, while still holding the bat, during a live ball situation, will be declared out. Should this be the third out of an inning, no preceding baserunner shall score.
- i. On a third strike foul ball.
- j. When hit by his/her own batted ball, in fair territory, outside the batter's box.
- k. If, on a fly ball, he/she fails to advance toward first base or remain in the batter's box.

RULE 7 Sec 10

THE BATTER OR BASERUNNER IS NOT OUT if a fielder making a play on him/her uses an illegal glove. The manager of the offended team has the option of having the batter bat over and assume the ball and strike count he/she had prior to the pitch he/she hit (baserunner return) or taking the result of the play.

RULE 7 Sec 12

Bunting is permitted only for female batters.

RULE 8 – BASERUNNING

NOTE I: First base double base — All GSA games use the safety bag at first base, and the following rules will be implemented. If the first play is at first base, either from the infield or outfield, a baserunner will be called out for touching the white or inside portion of the base. If the play is not to first base, the inside base may be tagged in a continuation toward second base. The baserunner running toward first base may cross over to the white or inside portion of the base to avoid a collision if a wild throw occurs. The white or inside portion of the base will be used by the batter-baserunner if attempting to get back to first base.

Rule 8 Sec 1

THE BASERUNNER MUST touch bases in legal order, that is first, second, third, and scoring line.

RULE 8 Sec 2

THE BATTER BECOMES A BATTER-BASERUNNER:

- a. As soon as he/she hits the ball.
- c. When the catcher obstructs, or any other fielder obstructs or hinders the batter from striking at or hitting a pitched ball:
 - 1. The umpire will signal, "delayed dead ball". The offensive team manager has the option of taking the base awarded the batter catcher's obstruction, or he/she may take the result of the play.
 - 2. If the batter reaches first base safely and all other baserunners advance at least one base on the batted ball, catcher's interference is canceled and no other options are given.
- d. When a fair ball strikes the umpire or baserunner on fair ground.
 - 1. If the ball hits the umpire or baserunner after passing an infielder, other than the pitcher or touches an infielder, including the pitcher, the ball is in play.
 - 2. If the ball hits the umpire or baserunner before passing an infielder, the ball is dead and the batter is entitled to first base without liability of being put out. Baserunners not forced by the batter-baserunner must return.

RULE 8 Sec 3

BASERUNNERS ARE ENTITLED TO ADVANCE WITH LIABILITY TO BE PUT OUT:

- a. When the ball is thrown into fair territory or foul territory and is not blocked.
- b. When the ball is batted into fair territory and is not blocked.
- c. When a legally caught fly ball is first touched.
- d. If a fair ball strikes an umpire or a runner after passing an infielder other than the pitcher, or having been touched by an infielder, including the pitcher, the ball shall be in play.

RULE 8 Sec 4

A PLAYER FORFEITS HIS/HER EXEMPTION FROM LIABILITY TO BE PUT OUT:

- a. If, while the ball is in play, he/she fails to touch the base he/she is entitled to before attempting to make the next base. If the baserunner put out is the batter-baserunner at first base, or any other baserunner, forced to advance because of the batter-baserunner, this is a force out.
- b. If, after over running first base, the batter-baserunner attempts to continue to the next base.
- c. If, after dislodging the base, the batter/batter-baserunner attempts to continue to the next base.

RULE 8 Sec 5

BASERUNNERS ARE ENTITLED TO ADVANCE WITHOUT LIABILITY TO BE PUT OUT:

- b. When a fielder obstructs a baserunner from making a base, unless the fielder is trying to field a batted ball, has the ball ready for a tag, or is about to receive a thrown ball.

EFFECT: When obstruction occurs, the umpire shall call and signal obstruction. If a play is being made on the obstructed baserunner, or if the batter-baserunner is obstructed before reaching first base, the ball is dead and all baserunners advance to the bases they would have reached, in the umpire's judgment, if there had been no obstruction, without liability to be put out.

EXCEPTION: A baserunner obstructed in a rundown shall be awarded the lead base at the time of the obstruction. Any preceding baserunners, forced to advance by the award of bases for obstruction, shall advance without liability to be put out. If no play is being made on the obstructed baserunner at the time of obstruction, the play shall proceed until the play is completed. The umpire shall call "time" and impose such penalties, if any, as in his judgment, will nullify the act of obstruction. If a fielder, without the ball, fakes a tag, the umpire may award the obstructed baserunner and each other baserunner affected by the obstruction, the bases they would have reached, had there been no obstruction.

- c. When forced to vacate a base because the batter was awarded a base for catcher's obstruction.
- d. When a fielder contacts or catches a batted or thrown ball with his/her cap, glove, or any part of his/her uniform while detached from its proper place.

NOTE I: The umpire(s) will signal "delayed dead ball".

1. The ball is dead. In all cases where a thrown ball goes into the spectator's seats, goes over, through, or under any fence surrounding the playing field, hits any person or object not engaged in the game, goes into the players' benches, including bats lying near benches, whether the ball rebounds onto the playing field or not, or remains in the meshes of any wire screen, each and every baserunner shall be awarded two (2) bases from the last base they occupied.

2. When the first throw is made by an infielder, two (2) bases shall be awarded. The award shall be governed by the position of each baserunner at the time the pitch was made, however, if all baserunners, including the batter-baserunner, have advanced at least one (1) base when the infielder makes the wild throw, on the first play after a pitch, the award shall be governed by the position of the baserunners when a wild throw was made.

3. When a throw is made by an outfielder or is the result of any succeeding play or attempted play, the two (2) base award shall be governed by the position of each baserunner and the last base he/she has touched at the time the throw was made. If two (2) baserunners are between the same base, the award is based on the position of the lead baserunner.

4. When a fielder loses possession of the ball, such as on an attempted tag, and the ball enters a dead ball area or becomes blocked, all runners are awarded one (1) base from the last base they occupied at the time the ball entered the dead ball area or became blocked. If a baserunner touches the next base and returns to his/her original base, the original base he/she left, is considered the "last base occupied" for the purposes of an overthrow award.

f. When a ball bounds or rolls into a stand, over, under, or through a fence, bounds out of play unintentionally off a defensive player or other obstruction marking the boundaries of the playing field.

EFFECT: Rule 8, Sec. 5(f) The ball is dead, and all baserunners are awarded two (2) bases from the time of the pitch.

g. When a live ball is unintentionally carried by a fielder from playable territory into a dead ball area, the ball becomes dead. All baserunners are awarded one(1) base from the last base touched at the time the fielder enters dead ball territory. If, in the judgment of the umpire, a fielder intentionally carries a live ball into dead ball territory, the ball becomes dead, and all baserunners are awarded two (2) bases from the last base they occupied at the time he/she entered the dead ball area.

EFFECT: A fielder carrying alive ball into the dugout or team area, to tag a player, is considered to have intentionally carried it there. A dead ball line is considered in play.

RULE 8 Sec 6

A BASERUNNER MUST RETURN TO HIS/HER BASE:

- a. When a foul ball is illegally caught and so declared by the umpire.
- b. When the umpire declares an illegally batted ball.
- c. When a batter or baserunner is called out for interference. Other baserunners shall return to the last base touched at the time of the interference.
- d. When a pitched ball that is swung at and missed touches any part of the batter's person.
- e. When a foul ball is not caught.

RULE 8 Sec 7

BATTER-BASERUNNER IS OUT:

- a. When, after hitting a fair ball, he/she is legally touched with the ball before he/she touches first base.
 - b. When, after hitting a fair ball, the ball is held by a fielder touching first base with any part of his/her person, before the batter-baserunner touches first base.
 - c. When, after a fly ball is hit, a fielder catches the ball before it touches the ground or any object other than a fielder.
 - d. When, after hitting a fair ball, he/she fails to advance to first base and enters his/her team area.
- EFFECT: Rule 8, Sec. 7(a - d) The ball is in play and the batter-baserunner is out.
- e. When he/she runs outside the three (3) foot line, and in the judgment of the umpire, interferes with the fielder taking the throw at first base, however, he/she may run outside the three (3) foot line to avoid a fielder attempting to field a batted ball.
 - f. When he/she interferes with a fielder attempting to field a batted ball, or intentionally interferes with a thrown ball. If the interference, in the judgment of the umpire, is an obvious attempt to prevent a double play, the baserunner closest to home plate shall be called out.
 - g. When a batter-baserunner interferes with a play at home in an attempt to prevent an obvious out at home plate, the baserunner is also out.
 - h. When he/she moves back towards home plate between first and home to avoid or delay a tag by a fielder.
 - i. When he/she is discovered using an altered or illegal bat.

EFFECT: Rule 8, Sec. 7(e - i) The ball is dead, and the batter-baserunner is out. Other baserunners must return to the last base legally touched at the time of the illegal action.

RULE 8 Sec 8

THE BASERUNNER IS OUT:

- a. When, in running to any base, he/she runs more than three feet from a direct line between that base and the next base in regular or reverse order to avoid being touched by the ball in the hand of a fielder. When a play, such as a rundown, is made on a runner who has "rounded" a base, and that runner is outside of a direct line between bases, the runner establishes his/her baseline as a direct line between him/her and the next base in regular or reverse order.
- b. When, while the ball is in play, he/she is legally touched by the ball in the hand of a fielder while not in contact with a base.
- c. When, on a force out, a fielder tags him/her with the ball or tags the base on a force out.

- d. When the baserunner fails to return to touch the base he/she previously occupied when play is resumed after suspension of play.
- e. When a baserunner physically passes a preceding baserunner before that baserunner has been put out.
- f. When the baserunner leaves his/her base to advance to another base before a caught fly ball has been touched by a fielder, provided the ball is returned to a fielder and legally held on that base, or a fielder legally touches the baserunner before he/she returns to his/her base.
- g. When the baserunner fails to touch the intervening base or bases, in regular or reverse order, and the ball is in play and legally held on the base, or the baserunner is legally touched while off the base he/she missed.
- h. When the batter-baserunner legally over runs first base and then attempts to run to second base and is legally touched while off the base.
- i. When the baserunner interferes with a fielder attempting to field a batted ball, or intentionally interferes with a thrown ball. If this interference, in the judgment of the umpire, is an obvious attempt to prevent a double play, and occurs before the baserunner is put out, the immediate succeeding baserunner shall be called out also.
- j. When a baserunner is struck with a fair-batted ball in fair territory while off base and before it passes an infielder, excluding the pitcher.
- k. When a baserunner intentionally kicks a ball, which an infielder has missed.
- l. When, with a baserunner on third base, the batter interferes with a play being made at home plate with less than two (2) outs.
- m. When anyone, other than another baserunner, physically assists a baserunner while the ball is in play.
Note: The contact must in some way assist the runner in obtaining the next base.
- r. When a baserunner, after being declared out or after scoring, interferes with a defensive player's opportunity to make a play on another baserunner. The baserunner closest to home plate, at the time of the interference, shall also be called out.
EFFECT: Rule 8, Sec. 8(j - s) The ball is dead the baserunner is out. Other baserunners must return to the last base legally touched at the time of the illegal action. Batter runner is awarded first base.
- s. When a defensive player has the ball and is waiting for the baserunner and the baserunner remains on his feet and deliberately, with great force, crashes into the defensive player, the baserunner is declared out. The ball is dead, and all runners must return to the last base touched at the time of the collision unless Rule 8, Sec. 8(j) or Rule 8, Sec. 8(s) applies.
NOTE I: If the act is determined to be flagrant, the offender shall be ejected.
- t. When the baserunner fails to keep contact with his/her base until a legally pitched ball has reached home plate. The ball is dead. "No Pitch" is declared and the baserunner is called out.
- u. When he/she abandons a base, does not attempt to advance to the next base, and enters the team area or leaves the field of play. The baserunner shall be called out immediately when he/she enters the team area or leaves the field of play.
- v. If hit by an infield fly when not in contact with the base. The ball is dead, and the baserunners and the batter are both declared out. Other baserunners must return to the base occupied, without liability to be put out, at the time of the pitch.
- w. He/she touches any part of home plate while the scoring line is in use, and their run does not score.

RULE 8 Sec 9

THE BASERUNNER IS NOT OUT:

- a. When a baserunner runs behind or in front of a fielder and outside the baseline in order to avoid interfering with a fielder who is attempting to field the ball in the baseline.
- b. When a baserunner does not run a direct line to the base, providing the fielder, in the direct line, does not have the ball in his/her possession.
- c. When more than one fielder attempts to field a batted ball, and the baserunner comes into contact with the one who, in the judgment of the umpire, was not entitled to field the ball.
- d. When a baserunner is hit with a fair-batted ball that has passed through an infielder, excluding the pitcher, and in the judgment of the umpire, no other fielder has a chance to make a play on the ball.
- e. When a baserunner is touched with a ball not securely held by a fielder.
- f. When the defensive team does not request the umpire's decision on an appeal play, until after the next pitch.

- g. When a batter-baserunner over runs first base, after touching it, and makes no attempt to advance to the next base.
 - h. When the baserunner is not given sufficient time to return to a base, he/she shall not be called out for being off the base before the pitcher pitches the ball. The umpire shall call “No Pitch”.
 - i. When a baserunner, who has legally started to advance, cannot be stopped by the pitcher receiving the ball while in the pitcher’s box.
 - j. When a baserunner holds his/her base until a fly ball touches a fielder, and then attempts to advance.
 - k. When a baserunner is in contact with the base, and is hit by a batted ground ball or fly ball in fair territory, the baserunner is not out, the ball is dead and the batter-baserunner is awarded first. All baserunners advance one (1) base only if forced.
- EFFECT: Ball is dead, all baserunners advance one base, if forced.
- l. When a baserunner slides into a base and dislodges it from its proper place. The base is considered to have followed the runner. See Rule 7, Sec. 1(c) and Rule 8, Sec. 4(c).
 - m. When a fielder makes a play on a batter-baserunner or baserunner while using an illegal glove. See Rule 7, Sec. 10 for option given to the manager of the offensive team.
 - n. When a fair-batted ball hits the baserunner, after it touches any fielder, including the pitcher.

RULE 9 – DEAD BALL - BALL IN PLAY

RULE 9 Sec 1

THE BALL IS DEAD AND NOT IN PLAY:

- a. When the ball is batted illegally.
 - b. When a batter steps from one box to another when the pitcher is ready to pitch.
 - c. When a ball is pitched illegally.
- EXCEPTION: If the batter swings at an illegal pitch, the play stands.
- d. When the umpire declares “No Pitch”.
 - e. When a pitched ball touches any part of the batter’s person or clothing, whether or not the ball is struck at.
 - f. When a foul ball is not caught.
 - g. When a baserunner is called out for leaving a base too soon on a pitched ball.
 - h. When the offensive team causes interference.
 - i. When the ball is outside the playing limits of the playing field. A ball is considered “out of play” when it touches the ground, person on the ground, or object outside the playing area.
 - j. If an accident to a baserunner prevents him/her from proceeding to a base, which he/she is awarded. A substitute baserunner shall be permitted for the injured player.
 - k. In case of interference with the batter or fielder.
 - l. When the batter bunts or chops a pitched ball.
 - m. When the umpire calls “Time”.
 - n. When the umpire calls “Time” and an appeal play follows, the ball remains dead throughout the appeal.
 - o. When any part of the batter’s person is hit by his own batted ball while he/she is in the batter’s box.
 - p. When a baserunner runs the bases in reverse order.
- EXCEPTION: If the baserunner is returning to re-tag a base.
- q. When, in the judgment of the umpire, a coach touches or physically helps a baserunner or when a coach near third base runs in the direction of home plate on or near the baseline while the fielder is attempting to make a play and thereby draws a throw to home plate.
 - r. When a baserunner fails to keep contact with his/her base, until the pitched ball has reached home plate
 - s. When a play is being made on an obstructed baserunner, or if the batter-baserunner is obstructed before he/she reaches first base.
 - t. When a blocked ball is declared.
 - u. When the batter enters the batter’s box with, or uses, an illegal bat or altered bat.
 - v. When a caught fair ball, including a line drive, which can be handled by any infielder with ordinary

effort, is intentionally dropped, with less than two (2) outs and with a baserunner on first, first and second, first and third, or first second and third bases.

w. When a fielder carries a live ball into dead ball territory.

x. When a foul ball is caught, and the batter has two (2) strikes.

y. When a batter is hit with his/her own batted ball, in fair territory, outside the batter's box.

z. When a fair ball strikes an umpire or baserunner on fair ground before passing or touching an infielder.

RULE 9 Sec 2

THE BALL IS IN PLAY:

a. At the start of each half inning, when the pitcher has the ball in the pitching position and the umpire has called "Play Ball".

b. When the infield fly rule is enforced.

c. When a thrown ball goes past a fielder and remains in playable territory.

d. When a fair ball strikes an umpire or baserunner on fair ground after passing or touching an infielder.

e. When a fair ball strikes an umpire on foul ground.

f. When the baserunners have reached the bases, to which they are entitled, when the fielder illegally fields a batted or thrown ball.

g. When a baserunner is called out for passing a preceding baserunner.

h. When no play is being made on an obstructed baserunner. The ball shall remain alive until the play is over.

i. When the batter legally hits a fair ball.

j. When a baserunner must return, in reverse order, while the ball is already in play.

k. When a baserunner acquires the right to a base by touching it before being put out.

l. When a base is dislodged while baserunners are running the bases.

m. When a baserunner runs out of the base line in regular or reverse order to avoid a tag by a fielder.

n. When a baserunner is forced or tagged out.

o. When the umpire calls the baserunner out for failure to return and touch the base when play is resumed, after a suspension of play.

p. When a live ball strikes a groundskeeper, photographer, policeman etc. assigned to the game.

q. When a thrown ball strikes an offensive player.

r. If the batter drops the bat and the ball rolls against the bat in fair territory, and in the judgment of the umpire, there was no intention to interfere with the course of the ball. The batter is not out, and the ball is alive and in play.

s. When a thrown ball strikes an umpire.

t. When a thrown ball strikes a coach.

u. As long as there is a play as a result of the hit by the batter. This would include an immediate live ball appeal before the umpire has called "Time", however, the ball will continue to be dead during a subsequent appeal play.

v. When a foul ball is caught, and the batter has less than two (2) strikes.

RULE 9 Sec 3

THE BALL REMAINS ALIVE until the umpire calls "Time", which should be done when the ball is held by a player in the infield area, and in the judgment of the umpire, all play has ceased.

RULE 10 – UMPIRES

NOTE I: Failure of umpires to adhere to Rule 10 shall not be grounds for protest. These are guidelines for the umpires.

RULE 10 Sec 1

POWERS AND DUTIES: The umpires are the representatives of the league or organization for the particular game, for which they have been assigned. They are authorized and required to enforce the rules contained in this book. The umpires have the power to order a player, coach, captain, or manager to do, or refrain

from doing, any act that is necessary to enforce any of these rules and to inflict any penalties prescribed. The plate umpire shall have the authority to rule on any situation not specifically covered in these rules.

NOTE I: An umpire shall not be a member of either team (i.e., player, coach, official scorekeeper, or sponsor.)

- a. The umpire should inspect the playing field, equipment, and clarify all ground rules to both teams and managers/coaches prior to the start of the game.
- b. Each umpire shall have the power to make decisions on violations committed anytime during playing time or suspension of play until the game is over.
- c. No umpire has the authority to set aside or question decisions made by another umpire within the limits of his/her respective duties.
- d. An umpire may consult with his/her partners at any time, however, the final decision shall rest with the umpire whose authority it is to make the decision and who requested the opinion of the other umpires.
- e. The plate and base umpires shall have equal authority to:

1. Call a baserunner out for leaving a base too soon.
2. Call "Time" for suspension of play.
3. Remove a player, manager, coach, or other team member from the game for violation of the rules.

NOTE I: Unless appealed, the plate umpire shall not call a player out for having failed to touch a base, leaving a base too soon on a caught fly ball, batting out of order, or making an attempt to go to second base after reaching first base, as provided in these rules.

RULE 10 Sec 2

THE PLATE UMPIRE:

- a. Shall take a position behind the catcher and have full responsibility for the proper conduct of the game.
- b. Shall count all balls and strikes.
- d. Shall determine and declare whether a batter chops or bunts a ball, whether a batted ball touches the person or clothing of the batter, and also whether a fly ball is an infield fly.
- e. Shall render decisions on the bases when required by the instruction in the umpire's manual.
- f. Shall determine when a game is forfeited.
- g. Shall be responsible for announcing the correct count when it is requested.

RULE 10 Sec 5

UMPIRE'S JUDGMENT:

There shall be no appeal of any decision of any umpire on the grounds that he/she was not correct in his/her decision that a batted ball was fair or foul, a baserunner was out or safe, a pitched ball was a ball or a strike, or any other play involving accuracy of judgment. Any argument is grounds for a player or coach to be ejected from the game. No decision of an umpire shall be reversed, except when he/she is convinced it is in violation of a rule. Under no circumstances shall any player or person, other than the manager or captain of either team, have any legal right to protest any decision and seeks its reversal on a claim that it is in conflict with these rules.

RULE 10 Sec 6

SUSPENSION OF PLAY:

- a. An umpire may suspend play when, in his/her judgment, conditions justify such an action.
- b. Play shall be suspended when the plate umpire leaves his/her position to brush the plate or to perform other duties not directly related with the calling of a play.
- c. The umpire shall suspend play whenever the batter or pitcher steps out of position for a legitimate reason.
- d. The umpire shall not call "Time" after the pitcher has started his/her pitching motion, or while play is in progress. "Time" shall not be called until all action, in progress by either team, has been completed.
- e. When, in the judgment of the umpire, all immediate play is apparently completed he/she calls "Time".

RULE 10 Sec 7

VIOLATIONS AND PENALTIES:

- a. Players, manager, coaches, or other team members shall not make disparaging or insulting remarks to, or about, any opposing players, officials, or spectators, or commit other acts that could be considered unsportsmanlike conduct.
- c. The penalty for violations by a player is prompt removal of the offender from the game and grounds. For the first violation, the manager or coach may be warned. For second offense, the player is removed

from the game. The offender shall directly leave the grounds. Failure to do so will warrant a forfeiture of the game.

d. Any player or coach that leaves his/her position on the field, including the dugout, to argue balls and strikes, or to argue whether a batter stepped on or over home plate will be ejected.

RULE 11 – PROTESTS

RULE 11 Sec 1

PROTESTS SHALL NOT be allowed or considered if they are based solely upon a decision involving judgment on the part of any umpire.

RULE 12 – PROFANITY

RULE 12 Sec 1

ZERO TOLERANCE FOR VERBAL ABUSE OR THE USE OF PROFANITY TOWARD AN UMPIRE OR NSA CANADA OFFICIAL IN ANY LEAGUE OR TOURNAMENT PLAY:

a. Immediate ejection from the game.

EFFECT: The offending person(s) must immediately leave the field and has one minute to completely leave the facility until the game is over.

b. Failure to leave the game will result in a forfeiture of the ejected player's team for that game. Failure of the ejected player to leave the facility will result in a three (3) game suspension from league play or in tournament play, for the rest of the tournament.

RULE 13 – ABUSE

RULE 13 Sec 1

ZERO TOLERANCE OF PHYSICAL ABUSE OF ANY OFFICIAL /DIRECTOR or MEMBER OF NSA CANADA

EFFECT This shall be considered a Conduct Unbecoming of a member of NSA Canada and may be subject to suspension and/or probation from all NSA Sanctioned Leagues, Tournaments and Events.

NOTE The penalty would be decided by the NSA Canada Disciplinary committee with the right to appeal to this committee.